

SHREYA CHANDRA

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, PhD, Agricultural and Resource Economics (2020-present)
- **Fields:** Development, Labor, Organization
Yale University, M.A., International and Development Economics (2016-2017)
University of Delhi, B.A., Economics Honors (2013-2016)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Data and Decisions (Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley) (Fall 2022, 2024, 2025)
International Economic Development (Masters – MDP program, UC Berkeley) (Spring 2022, 2023)
Introductory Applied Econometrics (Undergraduate, UC Berkeley) (Spring 2021)
Development Economics (Undergraduate, UC Berkeley) (Fall 2020, 2021)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Associate, IPA / STC, World Bank (August 2023-August 2025)
• Led design, implementation and analysis of a large-scale, nationally representative RCT in Tanzania to estimate consumers' sensitivity to prices of mobile money transactions.

Professor Ted Miguel (Berkeley Economics) (June 2022-August 2025)
• Supported analysis and field implementation for various projects, including aging and cognition, causal effect of heat on cognition, relationship between climate and conflict, and migration and labor market trajectories in Kenya.

Professor Nick Tsivanidis (Berkeley Haas) (April 2021-August 2021)
• Developed high-frequency checks for survey data collection on public transit in Lagos, Nigeria.
• Analyzed survey data to estimate the impact of the roll-out of new public transit routes on service delivery (i.e., wait times, passenger loads).

Professor Tavneet Suri (MIT Sloan) (August 2018-May 2020)
• Analyzed Financial Inclusion Insights data to estimate the effects of mobile money on subjective well-being measures.
• Supported data analysis and implementation of a follow-up survey on the use of mobile money and women's empowerment in Kenya.
• Supported the implementation and quality control checks for an endline survey on the impacts of universal basic income on gender relations and family planning methods in Kenya.

Professors Natalia Rigol and Benjamin Roth (HBS) (August 2018-July 2020)
• Data analysis and implementation of a field survey to study the effects of financial and social incentives on the behavior of loan officers in partnership with a microfinance organization in Chile.
• Data analysis and implementation of a randomized control trial on the effects of digitizing government-to-people payments in Bangladesh.
◦ Designed and implemented a rapid response phone survey during the Covid-19 wave to help the government assess the extent of food-insecurity among beneficiaries, preferences for receiving their next benefit payment, and information related to Covid-19 – currently an [IPA Working Paper](#)
• Organized and developed training material on data quality control measures for local survey team in Bangladesh

Evidence for Policy Design India, IFMR LEAD (July 2017-May 2018)
• Led qualitative analysis and field work across various states in India to understand the barriers to women's mobile phone ownership and use.
• Implemented a pilot intervention to evaluate the effects of free internet access on internet use among young female factory workers.

SELECTED RESEARCH GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

STEG PhD Research Grant (£14,999) (August 2025)
Centre for Economic Policy and Research
Project: "Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth"

Hart Fellowship in Tamil Studies (\$1,500) (April 2025)
University of California, Berkeley
Project: "Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth"

CEGA Fall 2024 Development Economics Challenge (\$17,219) (December 2024)

University of California, Berkeley

Project: “Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth”

Private Enterprise Development in Low-Income Countries (£14,016)

(November 2024)

Centre for Economic Policy and Research

Project: “Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth”

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics (\$14,450)

(October 2024)

University of Chicago

Project: “Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth”

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics – Pilot Grant (\$7,500)

(September 2024)

University of Chicago

- Project: “Understanding Firm-Worker Matching Frictions: Evidence from India”

Berkeley Economists for Equity Small Grant Program (\$1,000)

(April 2021, May 2024)

Berkeley Economists for Equity, UC Berkeley

- Project: “Firm Size and Preferences for Workplace Amenities - Surveys”

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics – Pilot Grant (\$10,450)

(April 2024)

University of Chicago

- Project: “Firm Size and Preferences for Workplace Amenities - Surveys”

IGC Research Grant (£11,500)

(February 2024)

London School of Economics

Project: “Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth”

SurveyCTO Primary Data Collection Grant (\$2,376)

(December 2023)

- Project: “Firm Size and Preferences for Workplace Amenities – Surveys + Experiment”

CEGA Fall 2023 Development Economics Challenge (\$6,500)

(December 2023)

University of California, Berkeley

- Project: “Firm Size and Preferences for Workplace Amenities - Surveys”

ARE Summer Stipend (\$3,000)

(June-August 2023)

University of California, Berkeley

- Project: “Firm Size and Preferences for Workplace Amenities – Preliminary scoping”

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics – Travel Grant (\$2,500)

(January 2023)

University of Chicago

- Project: “Do firms withhold promotions? Evidence from India”

ONGOING PROJECTS

Flexible Work Arrangements, Wage Employment and Firm Growth (Dissertation Project)

- I conduct an experiment with 100 small manufacturing firms in India, where I incentivize workers to follow fixed work timings for a period of 4-weeks. I study the effects of increased worker coordination on the organization of production in these firms, along with subsequent effects on worker and firm productivity. Randomly varying incentive amounts will allow me to compare the costs of flexibility to firms (in terms of profits), with worker’s willingness to pay (measured as compliance with the incentive). *Analysis stage.*

Targeting short term loans to high potential market vendors (with Natalia Rigol and Benjamin Roth)

- Evaluate the impact of short-term, high-frequency credit product on high potential market vendors in India. *Implementation and Data collection stage.*

Estimating Willingness to Pay for Mobile Money Transactions in Tanzania (with Francis Annan, William Blackmon and Xavier Giné)

- Estimate consumer price elasticity of mobile money services in Tanzania by providing randomized discounts. *Analysis stage.*

Politics and Public Sector Productivity: Evidence from Indian Railways (with Utkarsh Kumar)

- Empirically test whether public-sector firms are captured by political interests; this project uses closely contested elections as exogenous changes to political leadership to test how politicians affect train delays – an output-based measure of productivity for the Indian Railways. *Analysis stage.*

OTHER

Proficient in **SurveyCTO, Latex, STATA, R, MS Office**, functional knowledge of **Python, ArcGIS**

Languages: **Hindi** (native), English (fluent)